PDF forms are not compatible with the Google Chrome PDF viewer plug-in. Chrome users should save the form, then reopen and complete with Adobe reader.

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

I chose enzymatic reactions as a topic, as I had studied them in previous years and had the opportunity to observe the experiments at a biochemistry lab. When narrowing down the topic to an RQ I had to consider materials accessible in my country, so I studied the effect of inhibitors on the cyclooxygenase-1 (COX-1) enzyme activity on arachidonic acid. I worked in the labs of the Biochemistry Department of a local university, as the instruments and materials required were not available at school.

I narrowed my research focus to investigating the effects of aspirin and acetaminophen on COX-1 activity. To this effect, I calculated the IC50, and lab work and posterior analysis showed that aspirin inhibited COX-1 catalysis.

With my findings in place, my next step was to polish the presentation and to focus background information on chemistry and not biology.

I regard my process as a success, as I achieved to answer the RQ, although the final graph does not show a strong correlation. The writing process was tiring, and limiting the amount of tables was challenging. I am proud of my work!

I have learned how to plan a research project and I have collaborated with university students´research.

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